

Santiago Hopkins

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EDUCATION

University of California, Berkeley

GPA: 3.81/4.0

B.S Mechanical Engineering, Minor in Computer Science

NCAA Division I Student-Athlete (California Men's Soccer)

Anticipated Graduation: 2025

EXPERIENCES

Zoox - Mechatronics Test Engineering Intern

05/2024 - 08/2024

Water Contact Angle (WCA) Measurement Automation Tool

- Developed design criteria and core functionality for an automated WCA measurement tool to accurately assess solar and natural degradation of hydrophobic coatings on onboard camera lenses, both in controlled lab environments and during routine maintenance checks
- Implemented using Python and C++, leveraging OpenCV2 for computer vision tasks and the LSQ-Ellipse library for precise ellipse fitting
- Applied Gage R&R methods to validate the on-fleet WCA automation tool, achieving $\pm 5^\circ$ accuracy, and reducing processing time by $\sim 60\%$

Characterization and Validation of Sensor Contamination Mitigation (SCM) Module Wash System

- Designed a validation procedure for alternative external gear pumps and solenoid manifolds to adhere to current Zoox cleanability standards
- Developed sturdy mounting fixtures for the pump and valve manifold using CATIA v6, enhancing functionality and limiting vibration
- Developed communication protocols with CAN for valve control and LIN for pump control, enabling 10hz pump motor state messaging
- Used IPEMotion, LabView, and Python to design user test interfaces to monitor pressure in real-time during the wash system cycle
- Created a 1-D hydraulic circuit model in GT-Suite, incorporating localized and distributed losses, and achieved approximately 8% accuracy

World Surf League | Kelly Slater Wave Co. – Mechatronics Test Engineering Intern

05/2023 - 08/2023

CFD Prototyping and Validation for Artificial Wave Generator

- Found optimal bathymetry shapes for novel and proprietary wave generation technology for commercial use using SimCenter STAR-CCM+
- Led CAD development and on-site implementation of experimental methods to validate CFD metrics, such as resultant force, vortex ratio
- Analyzed over 20 hours of wave video to analyze wave shape and logged and presented necessary metrics to inform design revisions

Cross-Shore Wind-induced Changes to Field-Scale Overturning Wave Shape

08/2023 - 12/2023

- In conjunction with USC and Scripps researchers on a continuation of this [project](#), published in Cambridge's Journal of Fluid Mechanics
- Quantified effect of differing wind speed and direction on wave shape using advanced CFD techniques, such as overset mesh

Formula Electric at Berkeley (ESAE Driverless) – Autonomous Mechatronics Lead

01/2023 - 09/2024

Autonomous Steering System

- Led development and integration of modular robotic steering system to mimic human steering inputs, achieving lock to lock steering in $< 1s$
- Specified system criteria, targeting 9Nm of torque and $> 100RPM$ for motor selection, retaining low-profile design and minimizing backlash
- Selected RMDx8 servo with high coil count, 1:6 planetary gearbox, and dual encoder. Verified output, finding optimal operating voltage
- Designed belt drive system with custom HTD-5mm pulleys, and built an in-house hall-effect absolute rotary encoder to prevent overturning
- Integrated driving motor via CAN communication, and configured microcontroller to perform rapid adjustments via a tuned PID controller

Autonomous Braking System

- Established design criteria and general timeline for the 1st iteration of an autonomous braking system for a Formula Student-style EV vehicle
- Designed an Emergency Brake System (EBS) via mechanical and electrical methods, enhancing existing fail safes for an 18ms response time
- Developed pneumatic circuit using pistons to pressurize front and rear brake hose in parallel w/ brake pedal, enabling safe testing methods
- Developed low-level controller for variable pressure regulator and solenoid valve, integrating pressure transducers and IMU acceleration data

Validation and Characterization of Autonomous Systems

- Completed DVP&R, accurately measuring the response time of our Autonomous Braking Systems passive fail-safe
- In collaboration with Simulation team, developed testing procedures to characterize assumed vehicle dynamics parameters

RESEARCH

Institute of Transportation Studies | Smart Cities – Undergraduate Research Assistant

05/2023 - 08/2023

- Using VTA traffic data, developed a robust Python model visualized with Kepler.gl to analyze traffic patterns in a scenario w/o public transit
- Began initial data acquisition and modeling for a scenario where the City of Berkeley removed 'Berkeley Barriers' from certain intersections

UC Berkeley EECS VR/AR Lab - AR Undergraduate Research

08/2024 - Present

AI Football Tutorials

- Used Scenic, a probabilistic language, developed in-house to construct specific soccer scenarios using Python and Unity Hub Editor
- Implemented ChatGPT API and proprietary player positioning model that allowed for robust positioning of user within custom scenario
- Leveraged dozens of hours of Fifa 22 positioning data to discover and tune weights of 6 different 'objects' of interest

SKILLS

Hardware: SolidWorks, CATIA v5/v6, Siemens NX, Ansys, Mechanical Design, Mechatronics, Controls, Robotics, CFD (STAR-CCM+)

Manufacturing: Technical Drawings, GD&T, CNC Machining, WaterJet, LaserCutting, FDM/SLA 3D Printing, Lathe, Mill, Drill Press

Software: Python, C++, ROS2, GT-Suite, IPEMotion, MATLAB, Machine Learning, Neural Networks